



WikiVoyage released

The WikiMedia foundation has finally released "WikiVoyage" – a crowdsourced travel guide. Check it here: <http://dgit.in/SATsq8>



Lomography scanner

A Kickstarter project called the Lomography Smartphone Scanner turns old 35mm film strips into digital pictures shareable via a smartphone

Smart SoHo

Backing up critical business data online is increasingly becoming a cheaper alternative with a myriad cloud backup services. While there's nothing wrong in services such as Dropbox.com and Nortonzone.com, if you just want some cloud to offload your business data on to. But we recommend investing in a dedicated service that offers support and other features.

Check out the likes of SpiderOak (www.spideroak.com) and SOS Online Backup service (www.sosonlinebackup.com) – the former encrypts and never deletes your data, offering a free 2GB service with the ability to backup and sync data across a host of machines including mobile devices, while the latter offers incremental backup and syncing of data from PCs and even attached network drives at an affordable price.

Backup offline as well

Another way to tackle data disasters is to always keep offline data backups to ensure there's minimal impact on

business and quick restoration of data. Of course, online backup solutions are equally important and shouldn't be ignored, but downloading data from the cloud can take time. Offline data backup policies, whether on a central server, NAS, just another always-on PC or an external drive, can be put in place and configured in a matter of minutes with the following applications.

For Windows machines, Windows Home Server offers the best experience in terms of ease of use and setup – it's got all the basic features as well. Do also consider tools such as Acronis True Image Home or Rsync – the latter being an acclaimed cross-platform backup software.

Mac users don't need anything else apart from Time Machine, a free tool already present in OS X which does the job. You can probably supplement it by purchasing a Time Capsule, a cute external drive that backs up data wirelessly through Time Machine.

Mobile shields

While most of us have desktop security software running around the clock, we may ignore mobile security apps or not attach as much importance to them as their desktop counterparts. From now on, don't. With the advent of BYOD (bring your own device) policy at workplaces, it's difficult to track where your office data travels – smartphones and tablets, we're looking at you. It's critical to counter the threat of mobile security.

Apart from trying out mobile apps from popular security vendors, check out Lookout Mobile Security (www.lookout.com) which does a pretty good job of securing your mobile device and the data on it, besides backing it all up in the cloud. The app is in a constant state of vigilance, safeguarding you against malicious app or connecting to an unsecure Wi-Fi hotspot, besides letting you remotely control and manage data on your phone through a Web browser and even find a missing handset. 

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